



Under Attack: Simulating, Surviving and Restoring from an Identity Threat

A live attack demonstration — watch a real auth consent attack compromise an entire SaaS environment, then see Veeam Data Cloud recover it.



Ben Young
Field CTO

Identity data protection is becoming a **board-level responsibility**

In 2024

600M

identity-based attacks every day

In 2025

↑32%

increase

58%

Of organizations expect the number of identities to grow in the next year

Identity as the Connective Tissue

Identity is no longer just an access layer, it is the control plane connecting your entire ecosystem

- **Human Users**

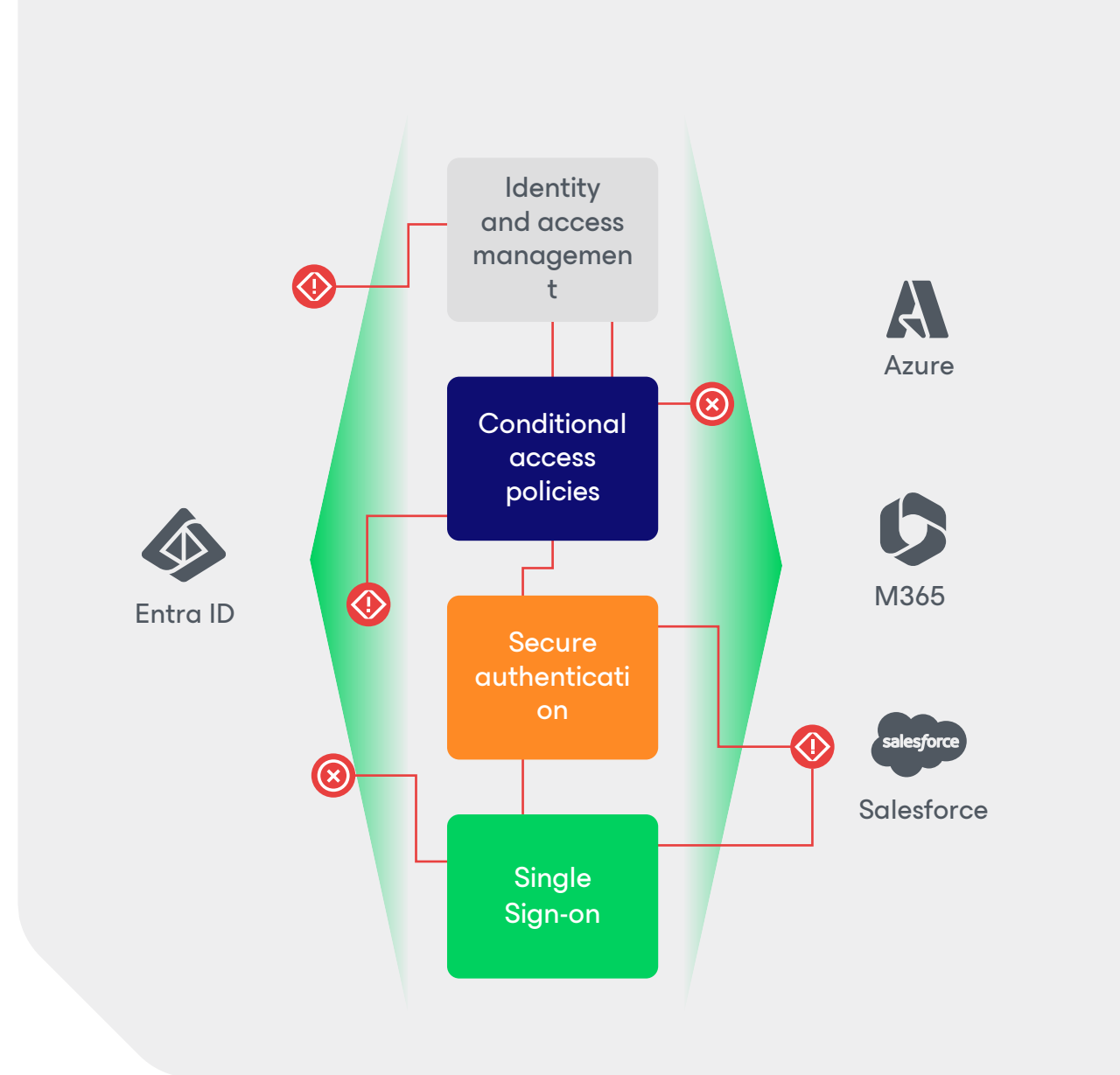
Administrators and employees accessing SaaS resources.

- **Machine Entities**

Cloud automation and hybrid infrastructure.

- **AI Agents**

Autonomous service principals with extensive permissions and access across workloads.



Your SaaS stack has one foundation. It's not your data.

M365, Salesforce, Workday, ServiceNow.

Every app your organisation runs trusts one system: who is this person, and what can they do?

That system is Microsoft Entra ID.

Not a login page. The trust layer your entire SaaS estate sits on. Compromise it, and SSO works against you. One identity unlocks everything.

Microsoft secures the platform. You secure what's inside.

Users, roles, policies, app registrations – are yours to protect.

Most organisations haven't.

The threat has shifted to identity

The perimeter has moved

Microsoft has hardened the platform — infrastructure attacks that worked a decade ago largely don't anymore. Attackers moved to the next weakest point: the identities and permissions organisations manage themselves.

93%

Of cyberattacks
now target identities

AI has changed the speed

Reconnaissance that took days now takes minutes. AI-powered tools identify high-value targets, create realistic campaigns. The “ishings”.

3x

Faster data exfiltration
with AI-powered attacks

Over-privileged access is the accelerant

When one identity is compromised, the blast radius isn't one user — it's everything that user, or their delegated apps, can reach.

67%

Of enterprises have excessive
data access permissions

Making Headlines

Key Takeaway

Identity is now the most critical—and vulnerable—attack surface, with attackers exploiting unmanaged accounts, weak configurations, and human error.

Silent Breach Exposes 16 Billion Passwords: 5 Things You Must Do Now

By [Emil Sayegh](#), Contributor. © Serial technology CEO covering all things IT & Tech.
Published Jun 30, 2025, 06:37am EDT

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Shadow Identities: Newest Risk Lurking in the Dark

Human and machine digital IDs, and the dangers they present

[Morey J. Haber](#), Chief Security Advisor, BeyondTrust
August 11, 2025

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ANDRIY POPOV VIA ALAMY STOCK PHOTO

Storm-0501 Hits Enterprise With 'Cloud-Based Ransomware' Attack

The financially motivated threat group used cloud resources to conduct a complex, ra enterprise victim.

[Alexander Culafi](#), Senior News Writer, Dark Reading
August 23, 2025

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Microsoft has called the hacker collective one of the most dangerous current cyber threats.

[Jai Vijayan](#), Contributing Writer
June 30, 2025

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Shared responsibility requires shared action

Microsoft delivers on the platform.

The infrastructure is solid. Authentication runs, datacentres are secure, uptime isn't the problem.

The identity objects your organisation creates inside it are.

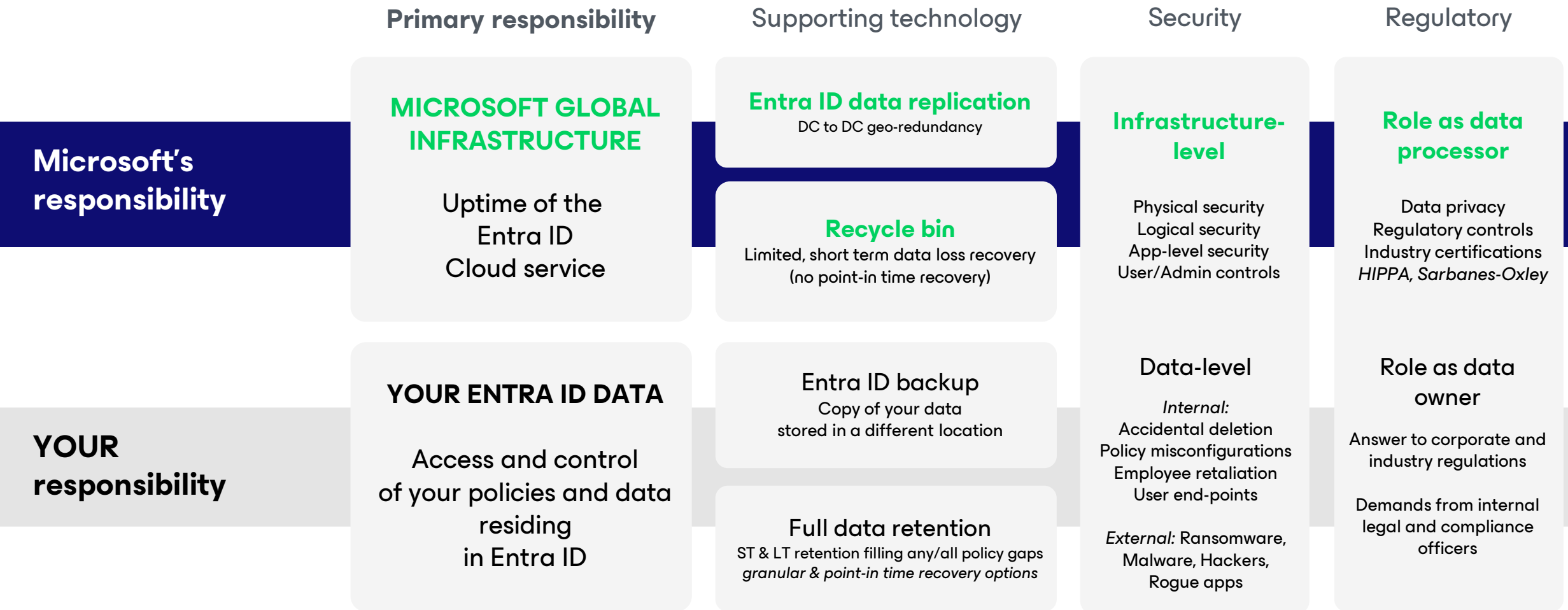
Users, roles, app registrations, conditional access policies sit on your side of the shared responsibility line.

Native retention handles routine mistakes within short windows.

But the 2024 Microsoft Digital Defense Report puts average breach detection at 207 days. Role assignments, conditional access policies, Intune device policies have no recycle bin. For objects that do, the grace period is 30 days.

That's not a platform gap. It's yours to close.

The Entra ID Shared Responsibility Model



Part 02

Setting the attack scene

How threat actors gain your trust and then exploit it

Threat actors are crafty

Threat Actors can, and do use use legitimate tools. This is called a “watering hole attack”.

An example;

1. Company profile for **“Nano-Cents AI”** is created on LinkedIn
2. Employee profiles copied from a similar AI startup
3. Threat actor uses LinkedIn’s built in marketing tools to target **people likely to have the mix of interests and privilege grants** within their Entra environment

This succeeds because it feels legitimate. It feels normal. No red flags. No suspicious domains. No malware.

For this demo... someone on your team clicked the ad.

The attack chain

Stage 1

Consent granted

Token issued. Attacker has immediate read access to email, files, and user data.

Stage 2

Persistence established

Malicious app registered with admin permissions. Survives password resets and MFA changes.

Stage 3

Identity destroyed

Backdoor admin accounts created. Legitimate admins deleted. MFA stripped. Conditional access removed.

Stage 4

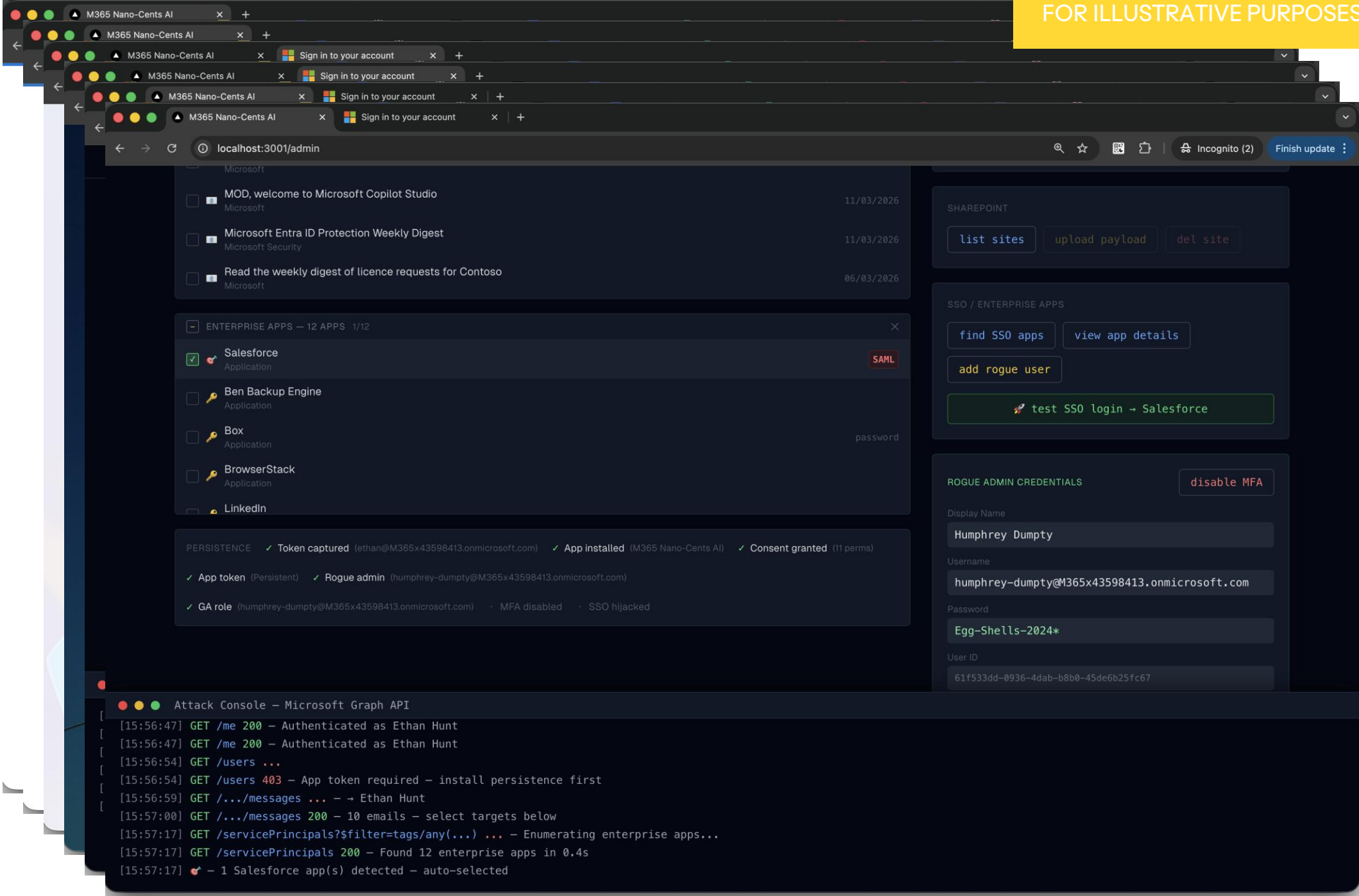
Lateral movement

Salesforce, Workday, ServiceNow. Any app trusting Entra ID via SSO is now accessible.

Part 03

Live Demo

Compromise, destruction and recovery



Part 04

Recap

What we just saw

The attack

- Victim was lured to malicious website
- Auth token captured via fake application consent
- Persistent malicious app registered with admin rights
- Legitimate admin accounts deleted, backdoors
- Lateral movement into Salesforce via SSO
- Corruption and deletion of data within M365, Salesforce and Entra ID

The Recovery

- Ability to recover Entra ID to a pre-attack state.
- Full granular ability to recover lost or corrupt Microsoft 365 data
- Salesforce records restored
- Audit log export preserved for forensic investigation
- Operations resumed — no full tenant restore required

Veeam Data Cloud

The Unified Cloud for Data Resilience



Backup/
Restore



Embedded
Security



Actionable
Insights



AI
Acceleration



Operational
Excellence

Shared services

Modern Multi-Workload UI/UX

Protected workloads



M365



Entra ID



Azure



Salesforce



Vault

Industry leading
technology

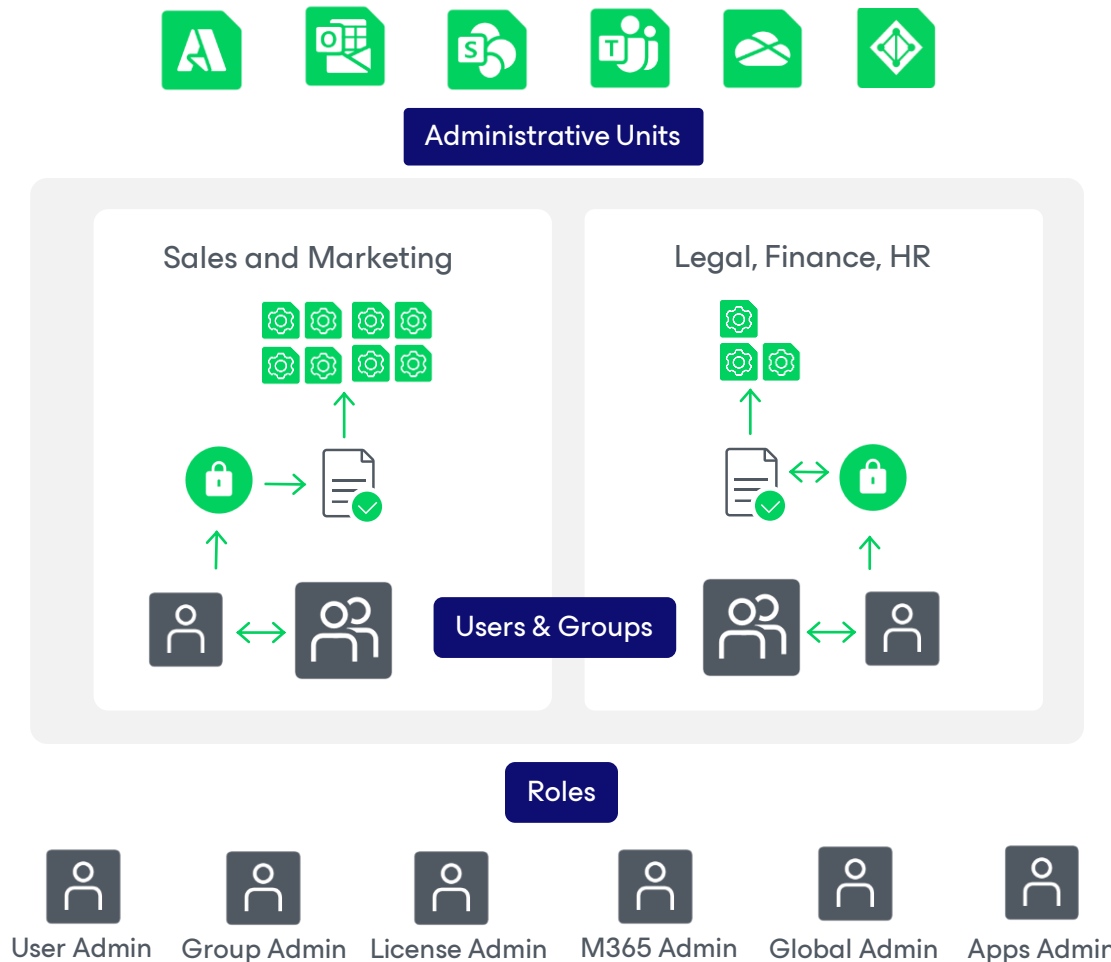
Gartner. IDC

Cloud-native
SaaS platform

Microsoft

Veeam Data Cloud for Entra ID

Microsoft manages the platform. Veeam manages your half.



Objects Veeam Protects

Applications

InTune Policies

Service Principals

Audit Logs

Conditional Access Policies

Sign-in Logs

Objects Veeam Restores

Granular restore

Compare to production

Ability to keep relationships

Log export for forensics

Sovereign or SaaS model

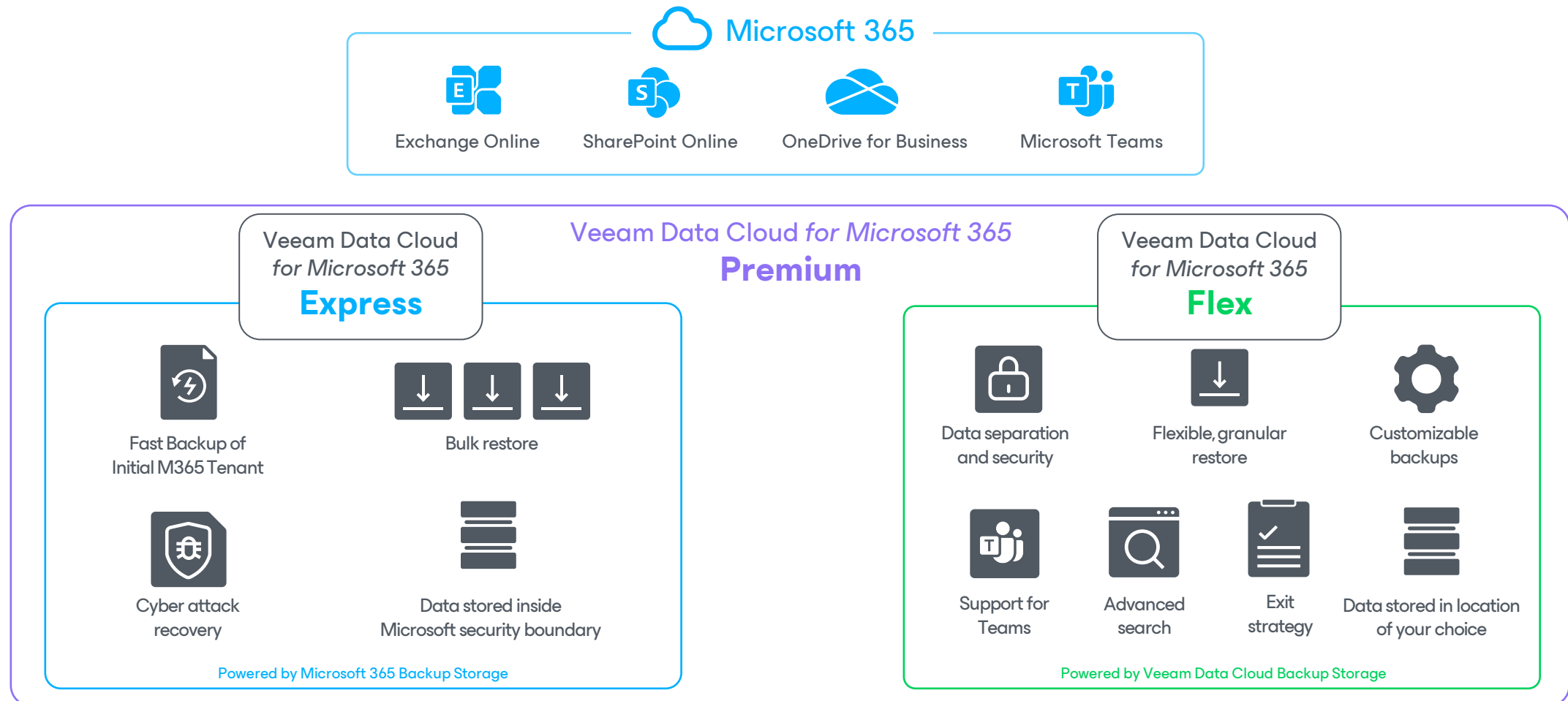
Metadata comparison

Surgical restore

Search

Veeam Data Cloud for Microsoft 365

Microsoft's backup solution is **embedded** inside Veeam's Microsoft 365 Backup Service, giving customers the best of both worlds - Speed and scale meets control and flexibility



Each backup is a separate, independent backup method embedded inside of Veeam's M365 backup solution.

Veeam Data Cloud

Advanced threat detection

New patent-pending ransomware and malware detection capabilities available for Microsoft 365... and soon for Entra ID!

Anomaly Detection

Automatically monitor backup activity in real-time, identifying unusual or suspicious behavior

Unified Threat Center

Patent-pending tech brings detection together in a single, centralized threat center.

Real-time Protection

Detects threats as they emerge, providing instant alerts and deep visibility into potential risks.



Four things to take away

01 The threat is real and accelerating

93% of attacks now target identities. AI has tripled exfiltration speed. OAuth consent attacks bypass every traditional security control. The scenario we just demonstrated is being executed against organisations right now.

02 Shared responsibility requires shared action

Microsoft's platform is secure. The objects your organisation creates inside it are your responsibility to protect and recover. Native retention handles routine mistakes within short windows. Your backup strategy needs to handle the rest.

03 Treat identity as infrastructure

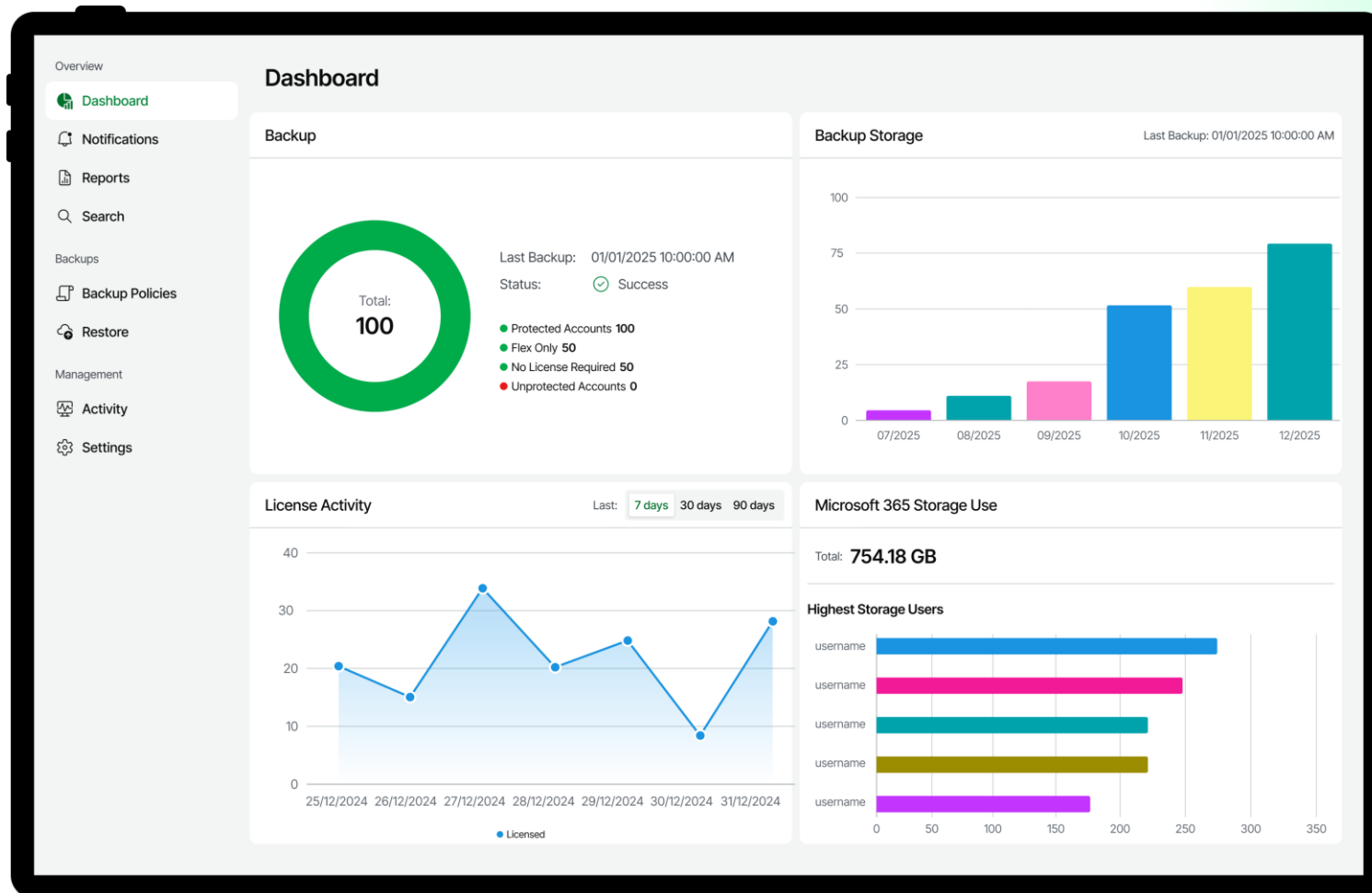
You backup your file servers. You backup your databases. Your identity system underpins all of it and has no backup by default. Veeam Data Cloud closes that gap today.

04 Veeam Data Cloud provides complete coverage

Veeam Data Cloud provides a secure, unified control plane for many of your critical workloads complete with centralized reporting and advanced threat detection.

Explore Veeam Data Cloud

See Veeam Data Cloud in action with an interactive product tour.



Scan Here





Find out your Microsoft 365 & Entra ID Data Risk Profile

Take this quick assessment to understand your organization's SaaS data protection strengths, gaps and opportunities for improvement with a custom report.

TAKE ASSESSMENT



Why It Matters

SaaS data is the backbone of modern business, powering everything from collaboration to identity and access. Many organizations face gaps in their data protection strategy that leave them vulnerable to cyberattacks, data loss, and regulatory penalties. With threats and compliance pressures on the rise, future-proofing your Microsoft 365 and Entra ID data is more important than ever.

Answer these questions below to find out your data risk profile:

Retention and Compliance

Step 1 Step 2 Step 3 Step 4 Result

Retention and compliance are critical for meeting legal, industry, and audit requirements. As of 2024, 65% of organizations are not fully protected, putting them at risk of data loss and penalties if they cannot prove compliance on demand.

How confident are you that your organization's backups meet all regulatory and business retention requirements for Microsoft 365 and Entra ID data?

☐ Not at all ☐ Slightly ☐ Somewhat ☐ Completely

Does your organization have automated compliance reporting and audit trails for all backup and recovery activities?

☐ Not at all ☐ Slightly ☐ Somewhat ☐ Completely

How easy is it for your organization to demonstrate data protection and recovery readiness to auditors or stakeholders?

☐ Not at all ☐ Slightly ☐ Somewhat ☐ Completely

NEXT >

Risk Profile Landing Page

Microsoft 365 and Entra ID Risk Report

Interactive quiz to evaluate your organization's Microsoft 365 and Entra ID data protection posture across key areas like backup, recovery, compliance, and monitoring.

This assessment helps you:

- Identify gaps and risks in current SaaS data protection strategies
- Benchmark the organization's risk level (Major Risk, Moderate Risk, Low Risk, or Resilient)
- Receive customized recommendations and actionable next steps to strengthen data resiliency via personalized report

go.veeam.com/m365-eid-data-risk-profile

Upcoming Webinar

The AI Trust Gap: How to Ensure Your Security Stack is Ready for Autonomous Agents

We'll dive into how you can:

- Implement a **clear framework for proactively managing AI risk**.
- Establish a **foundation of data controls** to support AI models and use cases.
- **Enforce policy in real time** across agents.
- And more!

Who are our speakers?

- Chris Joynt, director of Product Marketing, Veeam
- Brad Linch, director of Enterprise Strategy, Veeam

When?

AMER – Tuesday, Apr. 21, 1 p.m. EDT

EMEA – Wednesday, Apr. 22, 12 p.m. CEST, SAARC 3:30 p.m. IST

APJ – Wednesday, Apr. 22, 1:30 p.m. AEST, 11:30 a.m. SGT

**Save your seat –
register now!**





Thank You